SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #18 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“People like us don't go to college.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In some families, no one has gone to college, or college was something others did. Cost, fear of debt, a lack of information, a parent who feared losing a child to a different world, or a school that did not encourage it can all feed this belief. It can also be quiet: nobody forbade it, but nobody planned for it either. Many capable people never ask because they assume the door is not for them.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors wisdom and learning in many forms: the craftsman, the farmer, the scholar, the shepherd, and the merchant. Proverbs says wisdom is supreme, so acquire wisdom, and the heart of the discerning acquires knowledge. James says that if any of us lacks wisdom, we may ask God, who gives generously without finding fault. Paul tells us to work at whatever we do with our whole being, for the Lord. College is not the only path, and it is not for everyone, but the belief that “people like us” cannot learn or train further is not from God.

> *“Wisdom is supreme; so acquire wisdom. And whatever you may acquire, gain understanding”* (Proverbs 4:7).

Also see

> “The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out” (Proverbs 18:15).

> “Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him” (James 1:5).

> “Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men” (Colossians 3:23).

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

Common self-statements

- College is for other people.
- We cannot afford it, so there is no point looking.
- I am not smart enough.
- If I go, I will not fit in.
- My family would not understand.
- It is better not to hope.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I would fail or not belong.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating my family’s history as a rule for me.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring evidence of my ability and effort.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing college as the only path to learning or the only path I cannot take.

Challenging questions

- Who in my family or community told me this, and what experiences were behind it?
- What do I actually know about training options, costs, and aid?

- What have I learned or mastered already that shows I can learn?
- What kinds of training or schooling might fit my gifts?
- What would I try if I knew I could handle it?
- Who could I ask for information this month?

Truth summary

> God gives wisdom generously, and learning is open to people from every background. College may or may not be my path, but I can find out for myself instead of letting an old sentence decide. There are many good ways to grow, and I can take the next step with help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Intelligence
- Guidance
- Seeking
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Speak O Lord — Keith and Kristyn Getty
Receive God's Word with humility and allow truth to reshape thought and action.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

To God Be the Glory — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn celebrates redemption and forgiveness through Christ.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like us don't go to college"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like us don't go to college." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who told me college is not for me?
- ☐ What do I actually know about my options?
- ☐ What have I already learned to do well?
- ☐ What would I try if I knew I could?
- ☐ Who could I ask for information?
- ☐ What is one question I can ask this month?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can ask God for wisdom.
- ☐ Learning is for people like me, too.
- ☐ My ability is not decided by my family's history.
- ☐ There are many paths to training and growth.
- ☐ Asking questions is not presumptuous.
- ☐ I can start with one conversation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 4:7**
  "Wisdom is supreme; so acquire wisdom. And whatever you may acquire, gain understanding."
- ☐ **James 1:5**
  "Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him."
- ☐ **Colossians 3:23**
  "Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I learned about my options: Each week, write one new fact you found about training, schooling, or funding.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, James 1:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gives wisdom generously, so I can ask about my next step in learning.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write what you have learned. List skills and subjects you have mastered, in work, home, church, or school.
- [ ] Gather facts. Visit a community college, trade program, or counselor and ask about costs and aid.
- [ ] Talk with someone who has done it. Ask a person from a similar background about their experience.
- [ ] Share the plan. Tell your family what you are exploring so they can be part of it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like us don't go to college": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A fact about my options
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like us don't go to college.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You give wisdom to those who ask. Free me from the idea that learning is not for me. Show me the path that fits my gifts and give me courage to ask the first question. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.